



## Government User Guide

Acquisition Planning Forecast System (APFS) 2.0 FedRAMP

### Requirements Office Guide

*Version 1.7.1*

Prepared by BVTI  
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FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY

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## I Introduction

The Department of Homeland Security (DHS) Acquisition Planning Forecast System (APFS) provides a way for small business vendors to view upcoming opportunities. For further information about the data contained in the APFS forecast, refer to the 'About' button on the DHS APFS webpage.

The Homeland Security Acquisition Manual (HSAM) Section 3007.172 requires that non-sensitive planned acquisitions valued over the Simplified Acquisition Threshold (SAT) be published in APFS. Offices that want to publish planned acquisitions valued below the SAT are encouraged to do so. For additional details on planned acquisitions that must be published in APFS, please see HSAM Appendix H.

This tutorial will walk through the major functions that are available to **Requirements Office** users. It addresses common workflows and questions to familiarize the user with the function of the APFS System in a question-and-answer format. This tutorial includes the basic structure of the Dashboard, the life cycle of a forecast record, and responsibilities by user role.

## II APFS Functional Overview

There are two primary sides of the APFS system: Government and public. See Figure 1 for a visual depiction of APFS function. Government users in a variety of roles connect securely to the higher functions of the APFS application to create, document, manage, and approve DHS opportunities. On the public side, APFS allows industry to search for forecasted business opportunities and subscribe to notifications.

As shown in Figure 1, publishing an APFS record consists of four major steps:

1. The **Requirements Office** user creates the APFS record, completing all applicable fields and sends it to the Contracting Office queue.
2. The Contracting Office user locates the APFS record in his/her Contracting Office queue, claims the record, reviews it, updates it, and sends it to the APFS Coordinator Office queue.
3. The APFS Coordinator user locates the APFS record in his/her APFS Coordinator office queue, claims the record, reviews it, updates it, approves and publishes the record.
4. Once the APFS record is published, it is available for review by public users.

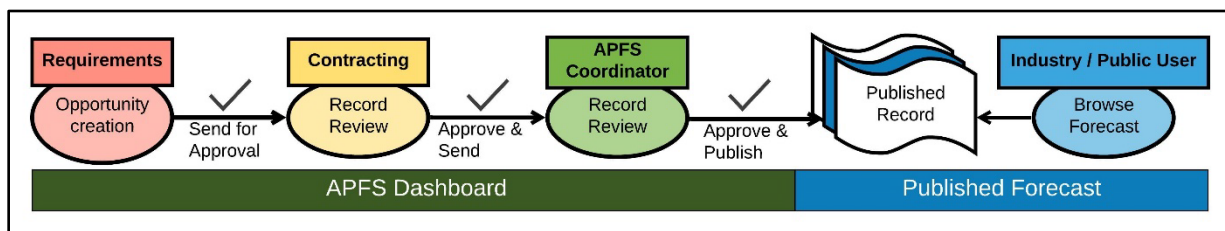


Figure 1: APFS Functional Overview

### III User Guide – Navigation and Login

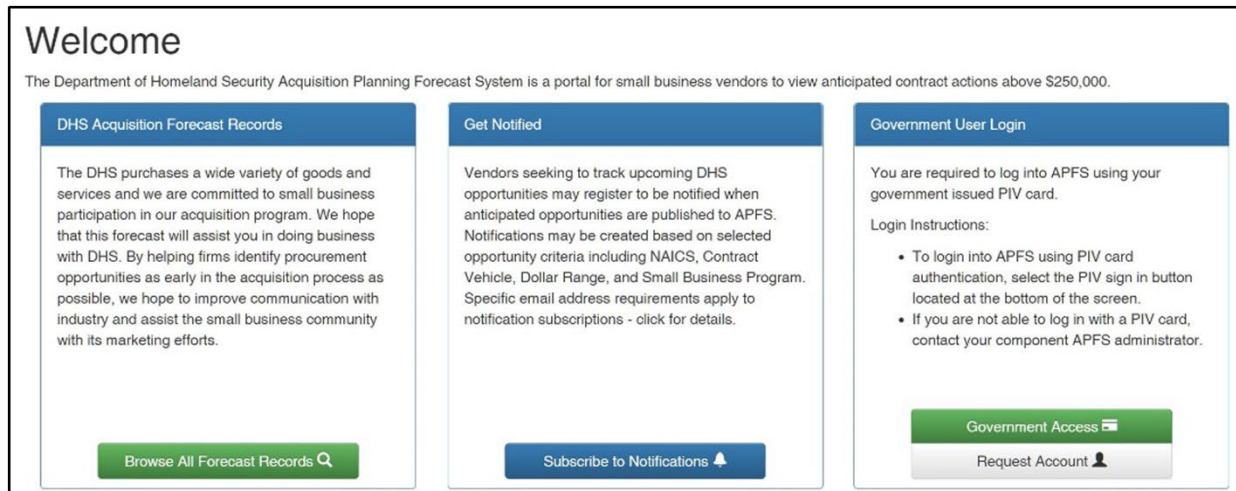


Figure 2: APFS Homepage Actions Panel

#### 1. How do I navigate to the APFS?

Open your web browser on your local internet-connected computer and navigate to the [APFS homepage web address](https://apfs-cloud.dhs.gov) (https:// apfs-cloud.dhs.gov).

#### 2. How do I log in?

Users who already possess an active APFS Government account and PIV card sign in with the following steps:

- Navigate to the Login screen by clicking the green 'Government Access' button on the APFS homepage actions panel (see Figure 2).
- Read and review the Terms and Conditions of Use statement. To proceed, click "I agree to the Terms and Conditions of Use."
- This will prompt login dialogue (see Figure 3).
- Ensure PIV card is inserted in reader. Click PIV Sign In. (See Figure 3 at A).
- You will be redirected to your APFS Dashboard (see Figure 5).

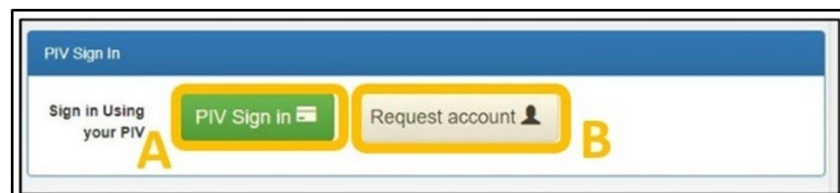


Figure 3: Login & Account Request

### 3. What if I don't have an account?

Users who don't have an account may request one using the following steps:

- A. Navigate to the Login screen by clicking the green 'Government Access' button on the APFS homepage actions panel. Click on the 'Request account' button (see Figure 3 at B).
- B. Fill out the Request Government Access to APFS form (see Figure 4) and after providing the necessary information click on the green 'Send your request' button.
- C. You will be notified via the email address you provided when your account has been created. (*\*NOTE: your request may take up to 5 business days.*)

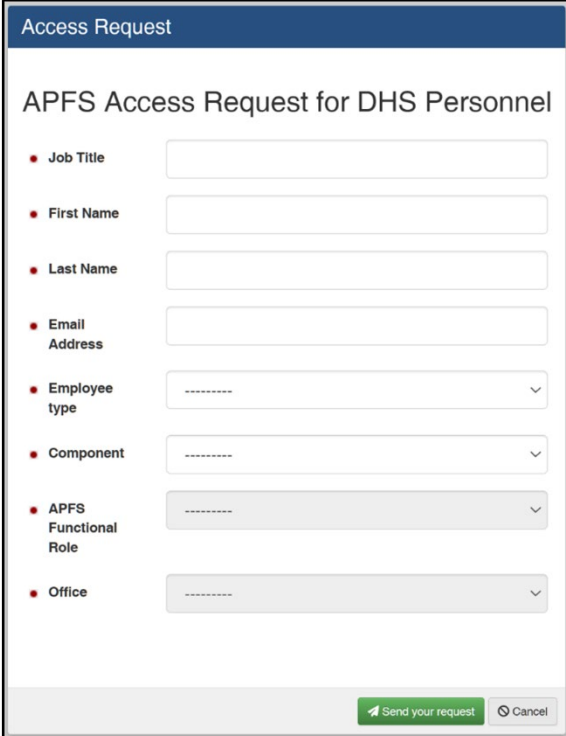
The form is titled "Access Request" in a blue header bar. Below this, the main title is "APFS Access Request for DHS Personnel". The form contains several fields, each preceded by a red dot icon: "Job Title" (text input), "First Name" (text input), "Last Name" (text input), "Email Address" (text input), "Employee type" (dropdown menu), "Component" (dropdown menu), "APFS Functional Role" (dropdown menu), and "Office" (dropdown menu). At the bottom right of the form, there are two buttons: a green "Send your request" button and a grey "Cancel" button.

Figure 4: Account Request Form

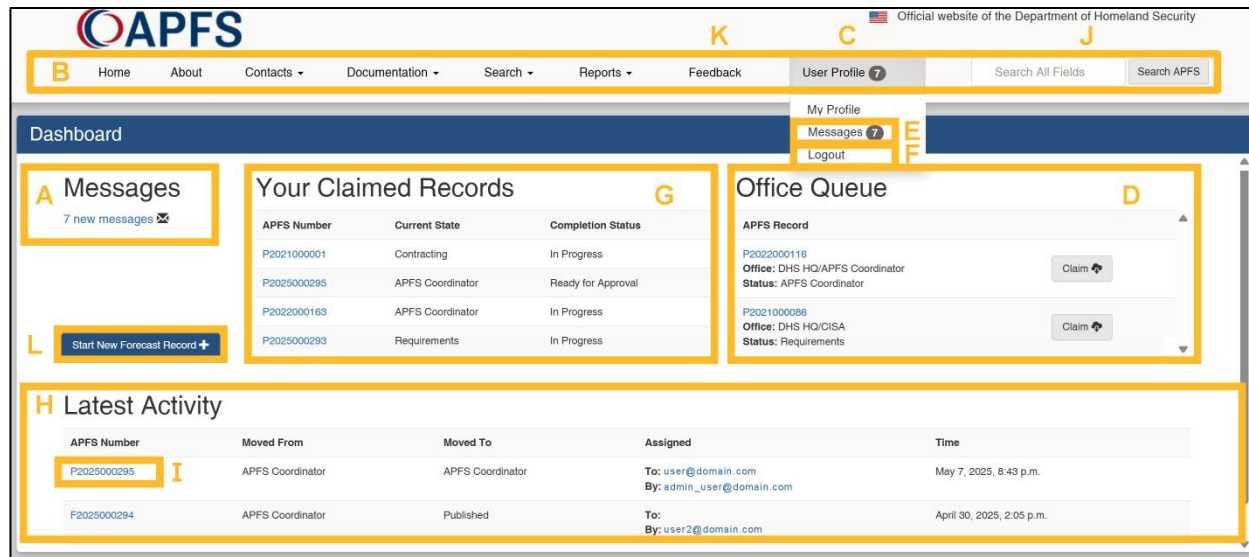


Figure 5: APFS Dashboard

## IV User Guide – APFS Dashboard

Once logged in securely, Government users can interact with the APFS forecast system in a variety of ways. Records arrive in the user's Office Queue (see Figure 5 at D), which is shared with all office members. Records must be claimed or assigned to a user, removing them from the queue and placing them in the claimed records in order to move to the next step in the approval process. The APFS Dashboard is shown in Figure 5.

### 1. What are the components of the APFS Dashboard?

The dashboard includes:

- A. Dashboard Messages Inbox: updated in real time to show automated system messages received.
- B. Navigation Bar: gives access to drop-down menus determined by user role.
- C. Message Bubble: indicates number of new messages in inbox.
- D. Office Queue: records currently open in your assigned office awaiting assignment and action.
- E. Messages: quick drop-down link to Message Inbox
- F. Logout Button: use this to log out to the public site.
- G. Your Claimed Records: open records assigned to you are listed here.
- H. Latest Activity: shows status changes of records assigned to your office as they occur.
- I. APFS Record Hyperlink: uses the text of the APFS number to link to a view of the record.
- J. Quick Record Search: enter any text in the box and click 'Search APFS' to search records.
- K. Feedback: give feedback on the APFS dashboard and tools to DHS.
- L. Start New Forecast Record Button: creates a new record.



## 2. How can I log out?

From the Dashboard navigation menu, select the 'User Profile' drop-down. Select 'Logout.' (See Figure 5 at F).

## 3. How will I know if I have messages?

- Any system messages you receive will be displayed in the Messages Box (see Figure 5 at A) on the Dashboard.
- Messages will also be indicated by a number in a black bubble (see Figure 5 at C) to the right of the 'User Profile' link on the main navigation bar (see Figure 5 at B).
- Clicking either the hyperlink text in the Message Inbox or the Navigation Bar Message Bubble will take you to your message inbox.

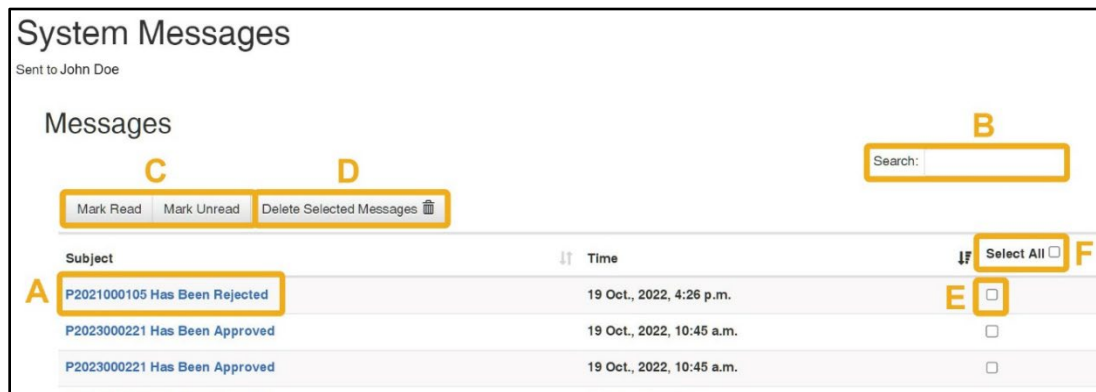


Figure 6: Message Inbox

## 4. How can I read my messages?

Read a message by selecting the email hyperlink subject link from the message inbox (see Figure 6 at A). Unread messages appear in bold, while read messages are in regular font.

## 5. How can I search for a message?

To search your messages, type any text in the text search box at the top right of the page (see Figure 6 at B). This will filter your messages and only display those messages with matching content. To stop filtering, simply clear the search box.

## 6. How can I mark messages as read / unread?

When you open a message, its "Read" status will automatically change to "read." To change the "Read" status of a message in your inbox, select the checkbox in line with the message in the "Select" column (see Figure 6 at E). Then, click the 'Mark Read' or 'Mark Unread' button (see Figure 6 at C). You may perform this operation on multiple messages simultaneously by clicking multiple checkboxes before clicking the button. To perform this operation on all messages in your inbox, click the "select All" box at the top of your inbox messages table (see Figure 6 at F).

## 7. How can I delete messages?

To delete one or more messages, click the checkbox in line with the message, then click the "Delete Selected Messages" button (see Figure 6 at D). You may perform this operation on multiple messages simultaneously by clicking multiple checkboxes before clicking the button. To perform this operation on all messages in your inbox, click the "select All" box at the top of your inbox messages table.

## 8. Can I send a direct message to a system user?

- A. No. The message inbox holds messages received through the unclaimed APFS system's automated notification system. These messages will be notifications of a change in a record's status.
- B. To communicate with a team member, please consult your organization's communication and email policies.

## 9. How can I view records requiring action?

In the 'Office Queue' box (see Figure 5 at D), you will find a listing of all the Forecast Records awaiting action within your assigned office, listed by APFS Number and their status in the approval process chain (see Figure 7). You can view Forecast Records by clicking on the APFS Number link and a read-only view of the record will be opened for review.

## 10. How can I see recent actions performed on my team's records?

- A. The Latest Activity Feed (see Figure 5 at I) displays the following at a glance:
  - i. **APFS Number:** references a specific Forecast Record.
  - ii. **Moved From:** shows the previous status of the Forecast Record.
  - iii. **Moved To:** shows the current status of Forecast Records.
  - iv. **Assigned:** shows the user who is currently assigned the record.
  - v. **Time:** the most recent activity is found at the top of the feed.
- B. Click the APFS Number hyperlink to open a read-only view of the record for review.

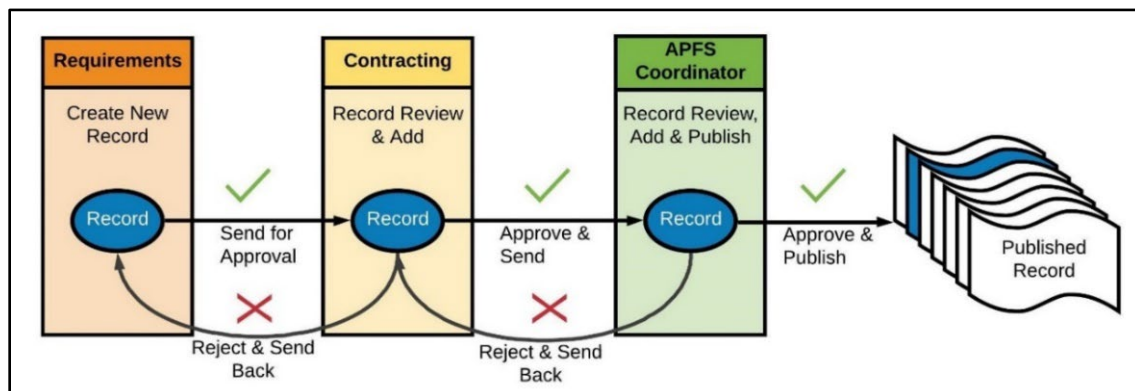


Figure 7: Record Approval Chain

## 11. How can I perform a quick search of APFS records?

From your APFS dashboard, you may perform a quick search of APFS records using a keyword. Type the desired term into the quick search box (see Figure 5 at J), then click the 'Search APFS' button. Resulting content will be displayed in the APFS record table (see Section V User Guide – Queue and Records) for more information on searching forecast records).

## 12. What if I have feedback?

You may send feedback on your experience with the DHS APFS system using the 'Feedback' email link (Figure 5 at L).

## V User Guide – Queue and Records

### 1. How can I create a new Forecast Record?

- A. Click the 'Start New Forecast Record +' button on the dashboard (see Figure 5 at L).
- B. Complete required fields in the Record Creation Form (see Figure 8 and Figure 9).
- C. Click 'Save & Continue.'
- D. Select relevant office.
- E. When record is completed, click 'Approve & Send.'
- F. Include optional comment if desired.
- G. Click blue 'Send to...' button.
- H. The record will be sent to the next point in the approval chain (see Figure 7). The record will pass from Requirements into Contacting and then pass to the APFS Coordinator Office for final edits, approval, and publication.

After saving the record, please select "Approve and Send" to route the record to the contracting office.

### Forecast Record

Starting a new forecast record.

Create New Forecast Record

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>APFS Number</b></p> <p>Automatically Generated On Creation</p> <p>This is assigned by the APFS Application.</p>                                                                                                    | <p><b>Component</b></p> <p>DHS HQ</p> <p>Select the Component, Subcomponent and/or Division.</p>                                                                                                                |
| <p><b>Requirements Title</b></p> <p>Enter in brief title to the requirement which will be included in the email to industry.</p>                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <p><b>Requirement</b></p> <p>Provide descriptive text detailing the requirements for the anticipated opportunity. Limit word count to 500.</p>                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <p><b>Program level</b></p> <p>A program level can be selected from the drop down menu if it applies.</p>                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <p><b>Small business set aside</b></p> <p>N/A</p> <p>If you intend to set aside a portion of this work for a designated Small Business Program, select the portion you would like to designate: 'Full' or 'partial'.</p> | <p><b>Small business program</b></p> <p>Choose a small business set aside and other options from the drop down for the anticipated opportunity.</p>                                                             |
| <p><b>Dollar range</b></p> <p>Select the dollar range for the total estimated value.</p>                                                                                                                                 | <p><b>NAICS Code</b></p> <p>Enter a North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) Code that pertains to the anticipated opportunity. Enter keywords in the text box to locate the applicable NAICS.</p> |
| <p><b>Contract type</b></p> <p>Choose the specific Contract Type from the drop down menu for the anticipated opportunity.</p>                                                                                            | <p><b>Will a strategic sourcing vehicle be used?</b></p>                                                                                                                                                        |
| <p><b>Strategic Sourcing Vehicle</b></p> <p>Choose the specific Contract Vehicle from the drop down menu for the anticipated opportunity.</p>                                                                            | <p><b>Type of Award</b></p> <p>Choose applicable award type from the drop down menu for the anticipated opportunity.</p>                                                                                        |

Figure 8: Create New Forecast Record Form

## Acquisition Planning Forecast System (APFS) FedRAMP

## Government User Guide – Requirements Office

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>Competitive</b></p> <p>Choose the status of the anticipated opportunity from the drop down.</p> <p><b>Incumbent</b></p> <p>Identify the incumbent in the text box.</p> <p><b>Estimated period of performance start</b></p> <p>The anticipated start date (mm/dd/yyyy).</p> <p><b>Fiscal year</b></p> <p>The Fiscal Year in which the planned requirement will be procured.</p> <p><b>Estimated solicitation release date</b></p> <p>The anticipated solicitation release date (mm/dd/yyyy).</p> <p><b>Place of performance city</b></p> <p>Enter the name of the city where the work is anticipated to be performed in the text box provided.</p> <p><b>Primary Contact First Name</b></p> <p>Enter the first name of the Point of Contact (POC) for this anticipated requirement in the text box provided.</p> <p><b>Primary Contact Phone</b></p> <p>Enter the phone number of the POC for this anticipated requirement in the text box provided. Format: (203) 555-1234 ext. 1234.</p> <p><b>Alternate contact first name</b></p> <p>(Optional) Enter the first name of the Alternate (POC) for this anticipated requirement in the text box provided.</p> <p><b>Alternate contact phone</b></p> <p>(Optional) Enter the phone number of the Alternate POC for this anticipated requirement in the text box provided. Format: (203) 555-1234 ext. 1234.</p> <p><b>Small Business Specialist/Component Admin First Name</b></p> <p>Enter the first name of the Admin (POC) for this anticipated requirement in the text box provided.</p> <p><b>Small Business Specialist/Component Admin Phone</b></p> <p>Enter the phone number of the Admin POC for this anticipated requirement in the text box provided. Format: (203) 555-1234 ext. 1234.</p> | <p><b>Contract status</b></p> <p>Identify if the contract is a new opportunity or a re-compete from the drop down menu.</p> <p><b>Contract number</b></p> <p>Notate the Contract Number in the text box provided.</p> <p><b>Estimated period of performance end</b></p> <p>The anticipated end date (mm/dd/yyyy).</p> <p><b>Anticipated award date</b></p> <p>The anticipated award date (mm/dd/yyyy).</p> <p><b>Place of performance state</b></p> <p>Select the state where the work is anticipated to be performed. If there are multiple cities and states, choose "Not Applicable" for the state, enter "Multiple" in the city field and list the locations in the requirement description field.</p> <p><b>Primary Contact Last Name</b></p> <p>Enter the last name of the POC for this anticipated requirement in the text box provided.</p> <p><b>Primary Contact Email</b></p> <p>Enter the email address of the POC for this anticipated requirement in the text box provided.</p> <p><b>Alternate contact last name</b></p> <p>(Optional) Enter the last name of the Alternate POC for this anticipated requirement in the text box provided.</p> <p><b>Alternate contact email</b></p> <p>(Optional) Enter the email address of the Alternate POC for this anticipated requirement in the text box provided.</p> <p><b>Small Business Specialist/Component Admin Last Name</b></p> <p>Enter the last name of the Admin POC for this anticipated requirement in the text box provided.</p> <p><b>Small Business Specialist/Component Admin Email</b></p> <p>Enter the email address of the Admin POC for this anticipated requirement in the text box provided.</p> |
| <p><a href="#">Save &amp; Continue</a> <a href="#">Cancel</a></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

Figure 9: Create New Forecast Record Form - Bottom

## 2. How can I view / edit my records?

- Users can view their assigned records by clicking on the APFS Number hyperlink within the 'Your Claimed Records' box (see Figure 5 at G).
- This will open the forecast record and allow you to scroll to view the record, modify fields, make additions, unassign, or finalize the record to ready it for publication Figure 5. Click the blue 'Save Record' button to apply changes.

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## Government User Guide – Requirements Office

**Forecast Record**

Modifying forecast record number P202000295.

This record is in APFS Coordinator and assigned to you.

**Printable View**  
**CSV Download**  
**Record History**  
**Change Log**  
**Reassign Record**  
**Record Actions**  
**Save**  
**Unstage**  
**Relist & Send Back**  
**Approve & Publish**  
**Delete**

**Requirements office**  
DHS HQ/CIS/MSMT/IDP

**Contracting office**  
DHS HQ/OPO/Cybersecurity and Infrastructure

**APFS Coordinator office**  
DHS HQ/APFS Coordinator

**APFS Number**  
P202000295

This is assigned by the APFS Application.

**Component**  
DHS HQ  
Select the Component, Subcomponent and/or Division.

**Requirements Title**  
LT test Req

Enter in brief title to the requirement which will be included in the email to industry.

**Requirement**  
SBS/Component Admin contract test

Provide descriptive text detailing the requirements for the anticipated opportunity. Limit word count to 500.

**Program level**  
If: Over \$300 Million

A program level can be selected from the drop down menu if it applies.

**Small business set aside**  
N/A

If you intend to set aside a portion of this work for a designated Small Business Program, select the portion you would like to designate: "Full" or "partial"

**Dollar range**  
\$1M to \$2M

Select the dollar range for the total estimated value.

**Contract type**  
Fixed Price Redetermination

Choose the specific Contract Type from the drop down menu for the anticipated opportunity.

**Strategic Sourcing Vehicle**  
Background Investigation Services II

Choose the specific Contract Vehicle from the drop down menu for the anticipated opportunity.

**Competitive**  
Competitive

Choose the status of the anticipated opportunity from the drop down menu.

**Incumbent**

Identify the incumbent in the text box.

**Estimated period of performance start**  
05/19/2027

The anticipated start date (mm/dd/yyyy).

**Fiscal year**  
FY2026

The Fiscal Year in which the planned requirement will be procured.

**Estimated solicitation release date**  
09/05/2025

The anticipated solicitation release date (mm/dd/yyyy).

**Place of performance city**  
Reston

Enter the name of the city where the work is anticipated to be performed in the text box provided.

**Primary Contact First Name**  
PrimaryFirst

Enter the first name of the Point of Contact (POC) for this anticipated requirement in the text box provided.

**Primary Contact Phone**  
(202) 555-1234

Enter the phone number of the POC for this anticipated requirement in the text box provided. Format: (202) 555-1234 ext. 1234.

**Alternate contact first name**

(Optional) Enter the first name of the Alternate POC for this anticipated requirement in the text box provided.

**Alternate contact phone**  
( ) - - - - - ext. - - - - -

(Optional) Enter the phone number of the Alternate POC for this anticipated requirement in the text box provided. Format: (202) 555-1234 ext. 1234.

**Small Business Specialist/Component Admin First Name**  
AdminFirst

Enter the first name of the Admin POC for this anticipated requirement in the text box provided.

**Small Business Specialist/Component Admin Phone**  
(202) 222-5554

Enter the phone number of the Admin POC for this anticipated requirement in the text box provided. Format: (202) 555-1234 ext. 1234.

**Contract number**

Notate the Contract Number in the text box provided.

**Estimated period of performance end**  
05/16/2028

The anticipated end date (mm/dd/yyyy).

**Anticipated award date**  
05/05/2026

The anticipated award date (mm/dd/yyyy).

**Place of performance state**  
Virginia

Select the state where the work is anticipated to be performed. If there are multiple cities and states, choose "Not Applicable" for the state, enter "Multiple" in the city field and list the locations in the requirement description field.

**Primary Contact Last Name**  
PrimaryLast

Enter the last name of the POC for this anticipated requirement in the text box provided.

**Primary Contact Email**  
primarycontact@state.gov

Enter the email address of the POC for this anticipated requirement in the text box provided.

**Alternate contact last name**

(Optional) Enter the last name of the Alternate POC for this anticipated requirement in the text box provided.

**Alternate contact email**

(Optional) Enter the email address of the Alternate POC for this anticipated requirement in the text box provided.

**Small Business Specialist/Component Admin Last Name**  
AdminLast

Enter the last name of the Admin POC for this anticipated requirement in the text box provided.

**Small Business Specialist/Component Admin Email**  
adminlast@bvt.com

Enter the email address of the Admin POC for this anticipated requirement in the text box provided.

**Save Record** **Cancel**

Figure 10: Edit Forecast Record Form

### 3. What do each of the record fields mean?

The fields that are found in the forecast record (See Figure 8 - Figure 9) are as follows:

1. Requirements Office: automatically populated by creator's requirements office.
2. Contracting Office: field to assign contracting office for record using the drop-down.
3. APFS Coordinator Office: field to assign APFS Coordinator office for record using the drop-down.
4. APFS Number: this is assigned by the APFS Application.
5. Component: using the drop down, select the Component, Sub, and/or Division.
6. Requirements Title: enter a brief title for this requirement. The title appears on the public forecast summary and table.
7. Requirement: enter a brief description of this requirement.
8. Program Level: a program level can be selected from the drop-down menu.
9. Small Business set aside: if you intend to set aside a portion of this work for a designated small business program, select the portion you would like to designate: Full or Partial, or select 'N/A.'
10. Small Business Program: choose a small business set aside and other options from the drop down for the anticipated opportunity.
11. Dollar Range: anticipated opportunity value.
12. NAICS Code: enter a North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) Code that pertains to the anticipated opportunity.
13. Contract Type: Choose the specific contract type from the dropdown menu.
14. Will a Strategic Sourcing Vehicle be used? Select 'Yes' or 'No.'
15. Strategic Sourcing Vehicle: This field is conditionally activated depending on the previous selection. If no, the dropdown is disabled and grayed out. If Yes, select an option from the dropdown menu provided.
16. Type of Award: This field is conditionally activated depending on the Strategic Sourcing status selected. If Yes, the dropdown is disabled and grayed out. If No, Choose applicable award type from the dropdown menu for the anticipated opportunity.
17. Competitive: choose the status of the anticipated opportunity from the drop down.
18. Contract Status: identify whether the contract is a new opportunity, a re-compete, or a follow-on from the drop-down menu.
19. Incumbent: This field is conditionally activated depending on the Contract status selected. If 'New Requirement' or 'The Requirement is no longer planned,' the dropdown is disabled and grayed out. If 'Follow-on to existing contract, PO, DO.TO,' identify the incumbent in the text box.
20. Contract Number: notate the Contract Number only if the opportunity is a re-compete.
21. Estimated Period of Performance Start: enter the anticipated start date for this forecasted work.
22. Estimated Period of Performance End: enter the anticipated end date for this forecasted work.
23. Fiscal Year: select the fiscal year under which the anticipated award date falls.
24. Anticipated Award Date: enter an anticipated award date (mm/dd/yyyy) or choose the date from contextual calendar provided.
25. Estimated Solicitation Release Date: enter the anticipated solicitation release date (mm/dd/yyyy) or choose the date from contextual calendar provided.
26. Place of Performance City: enter the name of the city where the work is anticipated to be performed.
27. Place of Performance State: enter the name of the State where the work is anticipated to be performed.
28. Primary /Alternate Contact /Small Business Specialist / APFS Coordinator Information: fill in the necessary information relating to the primary and alternate government POC and SB Specialist / APFS Coordinator for the anticipated requirement. Alternate contact information is optional.

#### 4. Which form fields must I fill in?

When creating a new record, each user role in the approval chain is responsible for certain fields in the record form. Fields to which you do not have edit access will be greyed out, and your cursor will display a red 'x.' Table 1 shows each field and the user responsible for inputting that field's data.

| Form Field                                 | User Responsible        |
|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Requirements Office                        | (System Auto-populates) |
| Contracting Office                         | Requirements User       |
| APFS Coordinator Office                    | Requirements User       |
| APFS Number                                | (System Auto-populates) |
| Component                                  | (System Auto-populates) |
| Requirements Title                         | Requirements User       |
| Requirement (Description)                  | Requirements User       |
| Program Level                              | Requirements User       |
| Small Business Set Aside                   | APFS Coordinator User   |
| Small Business Program                     | APFS Coordinator User   |
| Dollar Range                               | Requirements User       |
| NAICS Code                                 | Requirements User       |
| Contract Type                              | Contracting User        |
| Will a Strategic Sourcing Vehicle Be Used? | Contracting User        |
| Strategic Sourcing Vehicle                 | Contracting User        |
| Type of Award                              | Contracting User        |
| Competitive                                | Requirements User       |
| Contract Status                            | Requirements User       |
| Incumbent                                  | Requirements User       |
| Contract Number                            | Requirements User       |
| Estimated Period of Performance Start      | Contracting User        |
| Estimated Period of Performance End        | Contracting User        |
| Fiscal Year                                | Requirements User       |
| Anticipated Award Date                     | Contracting User        |
| Place of Performance City                  | Requirements User       |
| Place of Performance State                 | Requirements User       |
| Primary / Alternate Contact First Name     | Requirements User       |
| Primary / Alternate Contact Last Name      | Requirements User       |
| Primary / Alternate Contact Phone          | Requirements User       |
| Primary / Alternate Contact Email          | Requirements User       |
| SB Specialist / APFS Coord. First Name     | Requirements User       |
| SB Specialist / APFS Coord. Last Name      | Requirements User       |
| SB Specialist / APFS Coord. Phone          | Requirements User       |
| SB Specialist / APFS Coord. Email          | Requirements User       |





Figure 11: Record Tools & Actions

## 5. What record activities can be performed?

Depending on user role and permissions level, various activities and workflows may be available to a Government user. Figure 7 shows a visual representation of the lifecycle of a record.

The APFS record view contains two option boxes to export and interact with the record- the Record Tools box and the Record Actions box (see Figure 11).



| Acquisition Planning Forecast System |                                      |                         |                              |
|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------------|
| Forecast Record Number: P2021000045  |                                      |                         |                              |
| Component:                           | DHS HQ                               | Published Date:         | Previously Published On:     |
| Requirements Office:                 | DHS HQ OSA                           |                         |                              |
| Contracting Office:                  | None                                 |                         |                              |
| APFS Coordinator Office:             | None                                 |                         |                              |
| NAICS:                               | 111336                               | Competition:            | YES                          |
| Contract Vehicle:                    | IT - NITAAC ODOPS                    | Small Business Program: | HUBZone                      |
| Contract Complete:                   | June 1, 2024                         | Contract Status:        | New Requirement              |
| Estimated Solicitation Release:      | June 2, 2022 through June 1, 2024    | Anticipated Award Date: | Oct 1, 2021                  |
| Estimated Dollar Range:              | \$1,000,000.00 to \$2,000,000.00     | Fiscal Year:            | 2022                         |
| Requirements Title:                  | Test Title                           |                         |                              |
| Description:                         | Test record requirements description |                         |                              |
| Point of Performance:                | Marion, VA                           | POC Name:               | POC First Name POC Last Name |
| POC Phone:                           | (703) 281-4745                       | POC Email:              | poa@agency.com               |

Figure 12: Printable Record View

## 6. How can I print a record?

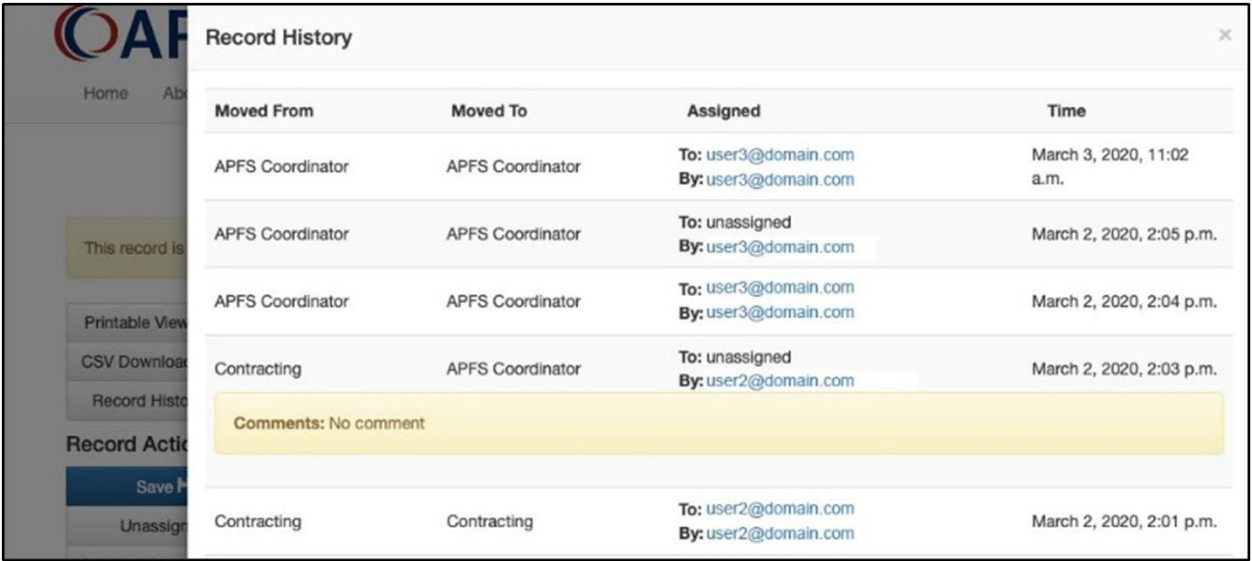
- You can open a copy of your record, formatted for optimal printing (see Figure 12), by clicking on the 'Printable View' button on the Record Tools box (see Figure 11).
- Use your browser's print option or CTRL/CMD + P to show a print dialogue.

## 7. Can I download a record?

To download a CSV of a record, click on the 'CSV Download' button positioned on the Record Tools box (see Figure 11) to save to the local drive.

## 8. How can I view a record's status history?

You can view the history of a published record by clicking on the 'Record History' button positioned on the Record Tools box (see Figure 11). A screen overlay will appear on the right side of the screen detailing the record's complete status history (See Figure 13).



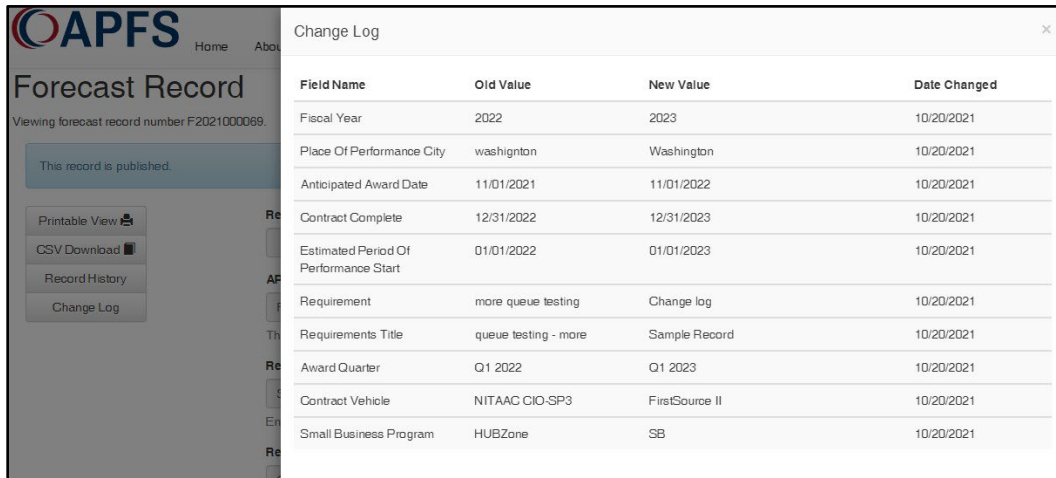
| Moved From           | Moved To         | Assigned                                     | Time                      |
|----------------------|------------------|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| APFS Coordinator     | APFS Coordinator | To: user3@domain.com<br>By: user3@domain.com | March 3, 2020, 11:02 a.m. |
| APFS Coordinator     | APFS Coordinator | To: unassigned<br>By: user3@domain.com       | March 2, 2020, 2:05 p.m.  |
| APFS Coordinator     | APFS Coordinator | To: user3@domain.com<br>By: user3@domain.com | March 2, 2020, 2:04 p.m.  |
| Contracting          | APFS Coordinator | To: unassigned<br>By: user2@domain.com       | March 2, 2020, 2:03 p.m.  |
| Comments: No comment |                  |                                              |                           |
| Contracting          | Contracting      | To: user2@domain.com<br>By: user2@domain.com | March 2, 2020, 2:01 p.m.  |

Figure 13: Record History



## 9. How can I view a record's changes over time?

Changes made to a published record after its initial creation are added to the Change Log. These changes will only be visible after the record's publication.



| Field Name                            | Old Value            | New Value      | Date Changed |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------|--------------|
| Fiscal Year                           | 2022                 | 2023           | 10/20/2021   |
| Place Of Performance City             | washington           | Washington     | 10/20/2021   |
| Anticipated Award Date                | 11/01/2021           | 11/01/2022     | 10/20/2021   |
| Contract Complete                     | 12/31/2022           | 12/31/2023     | 10/20/2021   |
| Estimated Period Of Performance Start | 01/01/2022           | 01/01/2023     | 10/20/2021   |
| Requirement                           | more queue testing   | Change log     | 10/20/2021   |
| Requirements Title                    | queue testing - more | Sample Record  | 10/20/2021   |
| Award Quarter                         | Q1 2022              | Q1 2023        | 10/20/2021   |
| Contract Vehicle                      | NITAAC CIO-SP3       | FirstSource II | 10/20/2021   |
| Small Business Program                | HUBZone              | SB             | 10/20/2021   |

Figure 14: Forecast Record Change Log

- A. To view the change log for a selected record, click the 'Change Log' button from the Record Tools box (see Figure 16).
- B. A Change Log overlay pane will appear from the right side of the screen (see Figure 14).

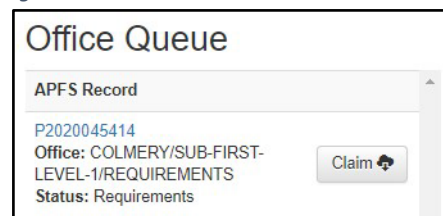


Figure 15: Claim from Dashboard

## 10. How can I claim an unassigned record?

A record may be claimed in two ways.

- A. From the Office Queue, click the 'Claim' button (see Figure 15). This will move the record into 'My Claimed Records' (see Figure 5 at G).
- B. Additionally, from within a read-only, unassigned Record, you can click 'Claim' (see Figure 16) to claim the record being viewed.

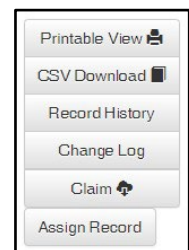


Figure 16: Unclaimed Record Tools Box

## 11. How can I unassign a record?

From within the Record view page of an assigned record, click 'Unassign' from the Record Actions Box (see Figure 17). Once unassigned, the record will return to the office queue to be claimed or assigned.

## 12. How do I delete a record?

To delete a record, select 'Delete' from the Record Actions box (see Figure 17) on the Record View page of a record you have claimed. \*Note: A record must be assigned to you in order to delete it.

## 13. How can I assign a record? (Queue Manager Only)

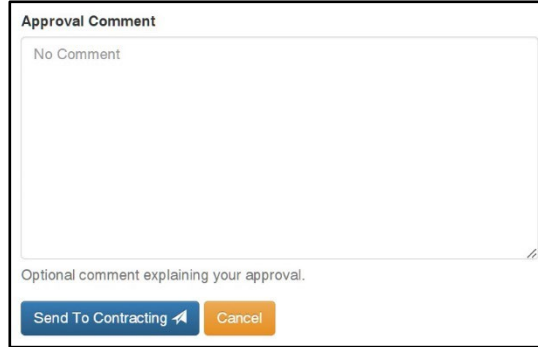
From within the Record view page of an unassigned record, click 'Assign Record' from the Record Actions Box (see Figure 16).



Figure 17: Record Actions Box

## 14. How can I approve & send a record?

- Select 'Approve & Send' from the Record Actions box (see Figure 17) on the Record View page of a record you have claimed.
- Optional: Write an approval comment in the form provided (see Figure 18).
- Click the blue 'Send to'... button.



The form is titled "Approval Comment". It contains a large text area with the placeholder text "No Comment". Below the text area, there is a smaller text area with the placeholder text "Optional comment explaining your approval." At the bottom of the form, there are two buttons: a blue button labeled "Send To Contracting" with a right-pointing arrow, and an orange button labeled "Cancel".

Figure 19: Approval Comments Form

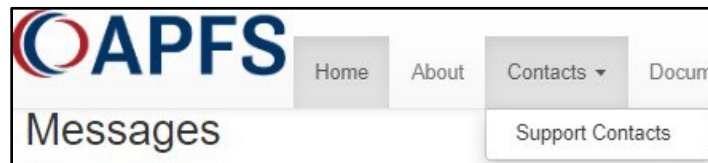


Figure 18: Contacts Drop-Down Menu

## 15. What if I need support?

If you need help using the APFS dashboard or its functions, navigate to Support Contacts in the 'Contacts' drop-down box (see Figure 19) and contact the appropriate POC (see Figure 20).



Figure 20: APFS Support Contacts

## VI User Guide – Record Search

### 1. How can I search forecast records?

Users can create browse and view APFS record reports within their scope of influence by navigating to the APFS Records Data Table. Results may be saved or printed. To begin, select 'Search All Records' from the

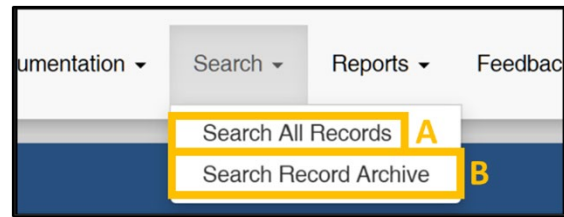
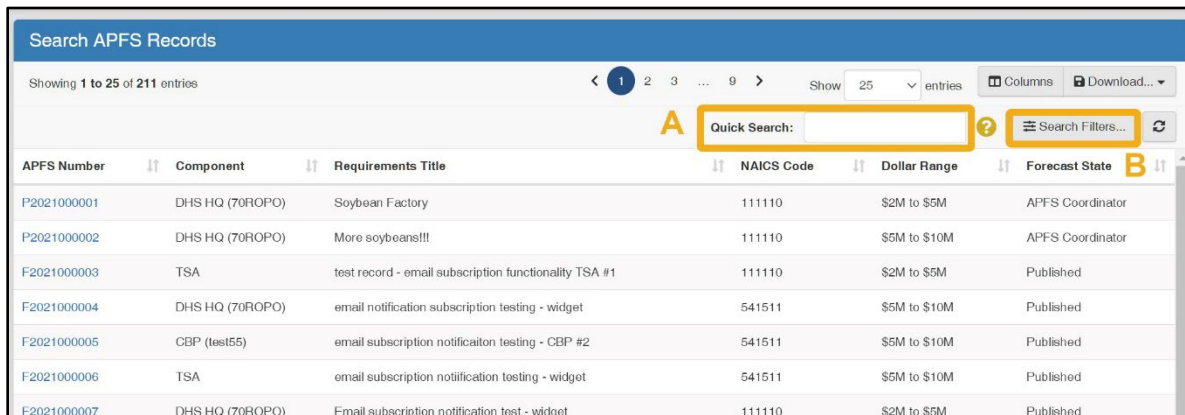


Figure 21: Search Menu



| APFS Number | Component       | Requirements Title                                    | NAICS Code | Dollar Range  | Forecast State   |
|-------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------|------------|---------------|------------------|
| P2021000001 | DHS HQ (70ROPO) | Soybean Factory                                       | 111110     | \$2M to \$5M  | APFS Coordinator |
| P2021000002 | DHS HQ (70ROPO) | More soybeans!!!                                      | 111110     | \$5M to \$10M | APFS Coordinator |
| F2021000003 | TSA             | test record - email subscription functionality TSA #1 | 111110     | \$2M to \$5M  | Published        |
| F2021000004 | DHS HQ (70ROPO) | email notification subscription testing - widget      | 541511     | \$5M to \$10M | Published        |
| F2021000005 | CBP (test55)    | email subscription notification testing - CBP #2      | 541511     | \$5M to \$10M | Published        |
| F2021000006 | TSA             | email subscription notification testing - widget      | 541511     | \$5M to \$10M | Published        |
| F2021000007 | DHS HQ (70ROPO) | Email subscription notification test - widget         | 111110     | \$2M to \$5M  | Published        |

Figure 22: APFS Records Table

'Search' drop-down menu (see Figure 21). Records in this table may be sorted by each column's data by clicking the "sort" button to the right of the column header.

- A. The Records Table displays all active records within the APFS under the user's sphere of influence. From the table itself, records may be selected or searched using either the Quick Search text box (See Figure 22 at A) or the 'Search Filters' pane.
  - a. To search all listed records on data that appears within the table, type any characters within the Quick Search box. The data in the table will instantly filter, displaying only resulting entries.
  - b. To remove the filter, simply delete the contents of the Quick Search box.
- B. Sometimes, user want to filter the list of records by other criteria not displayed in the table. To do this, click the 'Search Filters' button in the top right corner (see Figure 22 at B).
  - a. A basic search pane will be displayed, containing text fields for entries of "APFS Number" Requirements Title, and "NAICS." To search on other criteria, click the 'Advanced Search' link at the bottom of the pane to display additional filters (see Figure 23).

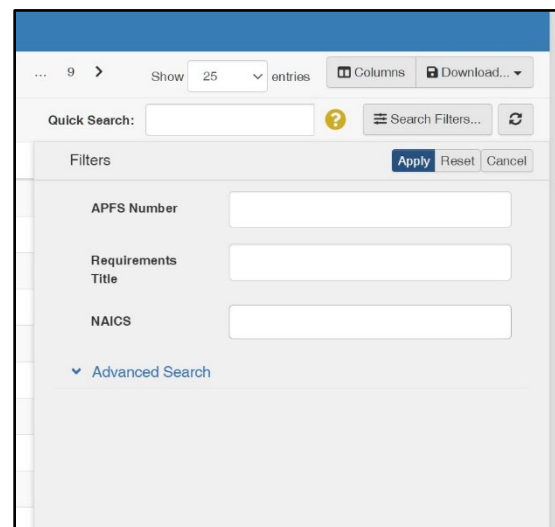
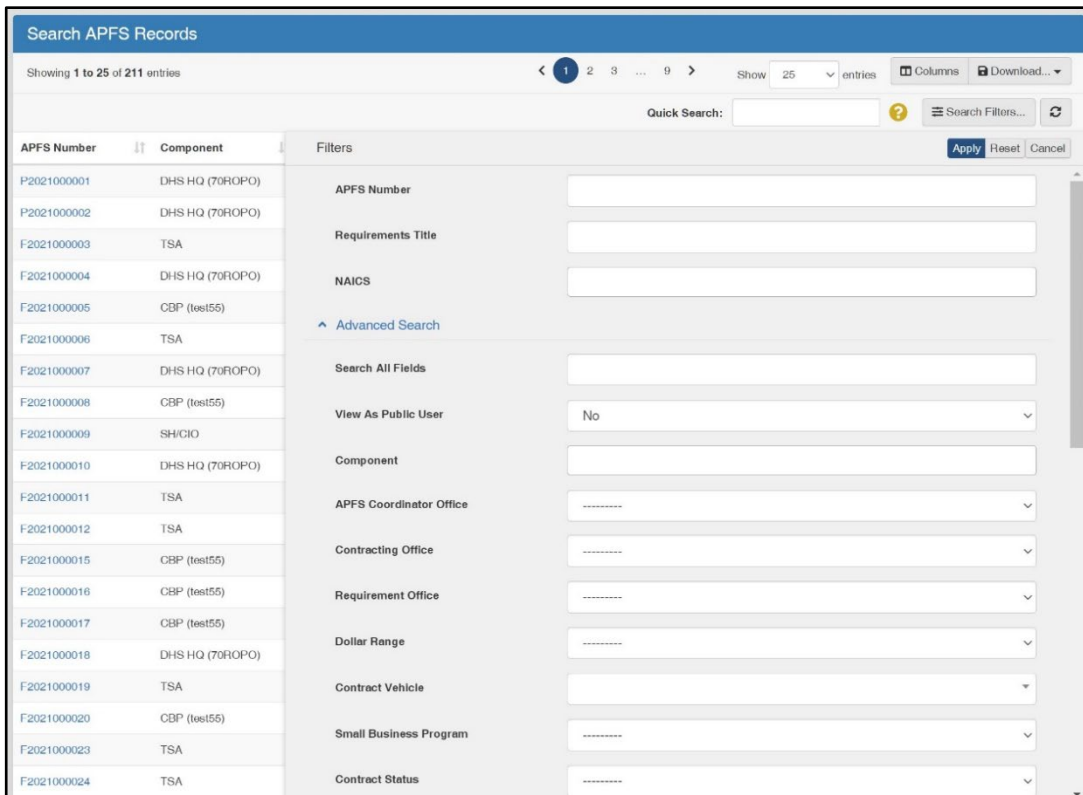


Figure 23: Basic Search Filters Pane



The screenshot displays the 'Search APFS Records' interface. At the top, it shows 'Showing 1 to 25 of 211 entries' and navigation controls. Below this is a table with columns 'APFS Number' and 'Component'. To the right of the table is the 'Filters' pane, which includes a 'Quick Search' field and a 'Search Filters...' button. The 'Advanced Search' section is expanded, showing various filter options with input fields or dropdown menus.

| APFS Number | Component       |
|-------------|-----------------|
| P2021000001 | DHS HQ (70R0PO) |
| P2021000002 | DHS HQ (70R0PO) |
| F2021000003 | TSA             |
| F2021000004 | DHS HQ (70R0PO) |
| F2021000005 | CBP (test55)    |
| F2021000006 | TSA             |
| F2021000007 | DHS HQ (70R0PO) |
| F2021000008 | CBP (test55)    |
| F2021000009 | SH/CIO          |
| F2021000010 | DHS HQ (70R0PO) |
| F2021000011 | TSA             |
| F2021000012 | TSA             |
| F2021000015 | CBP (test55)    |
| F2021000016 | CBP (test55)    |
| F2021000017 | CBP (test55)    |
| F2021000018 | DHS HQ (70R0PO) |
| F2021000019 | TSA             |
| F2021000020 | CBP (test55)    |
| F2021000023 | TSA             |
| F2021000024 | TSA             |

**Filters**

- APFS Number
- Requirements Title
- NAICS
- Advanced Search**
  - Search All Fields
  - View As Public User: No
  - Component
  - APFS Coordinator Office
  - Contracting Office
  - Requirement Office
  - Dollar Range
  - Contract Vehicle
  - Small Business Program
  - Contract Status

Figure 24: Advanced Search Filters Pane

- C. Using the Advanced Search filters pane (see Figure 24), records may be searched on any entered data within the record. To filter all records by selected criteria, make your selections in this pane and click the blue 'Apply' button at the top of the pane. Results may be saved as CSV containing all data, CSV containing only visible fields, and in "Bulk Update" format by clicking the "Download" button at the top of the table. The following filters can be used:
- D. Using the **Advanced Search filters** pane (Figure 24) records may be searched on any entered data within the record. To filter all records by selected criteria, make your selections in this pane and click the blue 'Apply' button at the top of the pane. Results may be saved as CSV containing all data, CSV containing only visible fields, and in "Bulk Update" format by clicking the "Download" button at the top of the table. The following filters can be used:
- APFS Number: Search for records by the assigned APFS number.
  - Requirements Title: Search for records by record title.
  - NAICS: Search for records by selecting one or more NAICS Codes.
  - Search All Fields: Search for records using a full text search of all fields.
  - View as Public User: Simulate a search by a public user; when 'Yes' is selected from the menu, only forecast records that are published and un-archived will be returned.
  - Component: Search for records selecting one or more component, subcomponent and/or division.
  - APFS Coordinator Office: Search for records by the selected APFS Coordinator Office.
  - Contracting Office: Search for records by the selected Contracting Office.
  - Requirements Office: Search for records by the selected Requirements Office.
  - Dollar Range: Search for records by the expected dollar range.
  - Contract Type: Search for records with a specified contract type.

- l. Contract Vehicle: Search for records by Contract Vehicle Category.
- m. Small Business Set-Aside: Search for records with a selected portion set aside for small businesses (e.g. Full, Partial, N/A).
- n. Small Business Program: Search for records by Small Business program.
- o. Contract Status: Search for records by 'New Contract' or 'Follow-On Contract.'
- p. Forecast State: Search for records by selected current status in the approval chain (Requirements, Contracting, APFS Coordinator, Published).
- q. Primary Point of Contact: Search the Forecast Records by the Primary Point of Contact Name.
- r. SB Specialist / APFS Coordinator Point of Contact: Search the Forecast Records by the SP Specialist / APFS Coordinator Point of Contact Name.
- s. Requirement Description: Search for records by keywords within the Requirements Description field.
- t. Last Updated By: Search for records by the user's email who last updated a record.
- u. Approved By: Search for records by the user's email who approved a record.
- v. Estimated Solicitation Release Date After: Search the Forecast Records with an anticipated solicitation release date falling after the selected date.
- w. Estimated Solicitation Release Date Before: Search for records with an anticipated solicitation release date falling before the selected date.
- x. Award Date After: Search for records with an anticipated solicitation release date falling before the selected date.
- y. Award Date Before: Search the Forecast Records with an anticipated award date falling before the selected date.
- z. Last Updated After: Search for records last updated after a specified date.
- aa. Last Updated Before: Search for records last updated before a specified date.
- bb. Creation Date After: Search for records created after a specified date.
- cc. Creation Date Before: Search for records created before a specified date.
- dd. Published Date After: Search for records published after a specified date.
- ee. Published Date Before: Search for records published before a specified date.
- ff. Fiscal Year: Search for records whose anticipated award date falls during a specified Fiscal Year.

E. To reset all filters, click the 'Reset' button at the top of the pane.

To cancel your search and return to the records table, click 'cancel' in the top of the pane.

## VII User Guide – Reporting

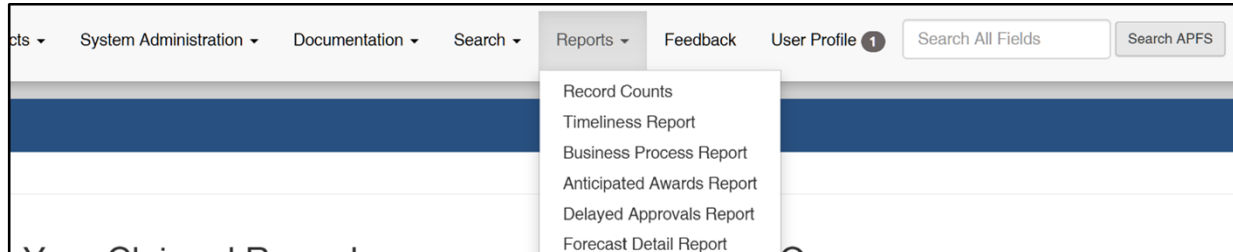


Figure 25: Reports Menu

### 1. How can I view reports of records under my influence?

You may view the standard reports by clicking on the appropriate button under the 'Reports' drop-down menu in the Navigation Bar (see Figure 25). Generating a report starts with the Report Filter Form (see Figure 26).

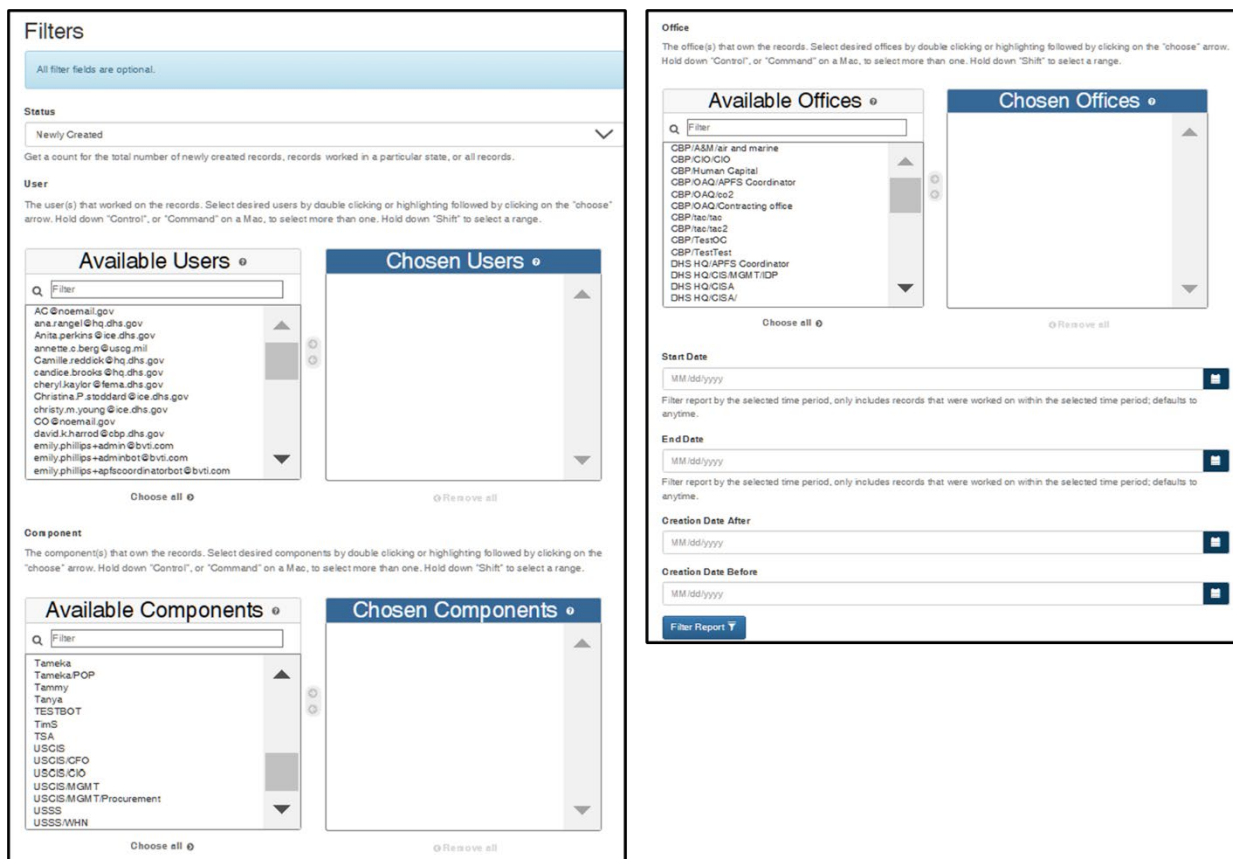


Figure 26: Report Filter Form



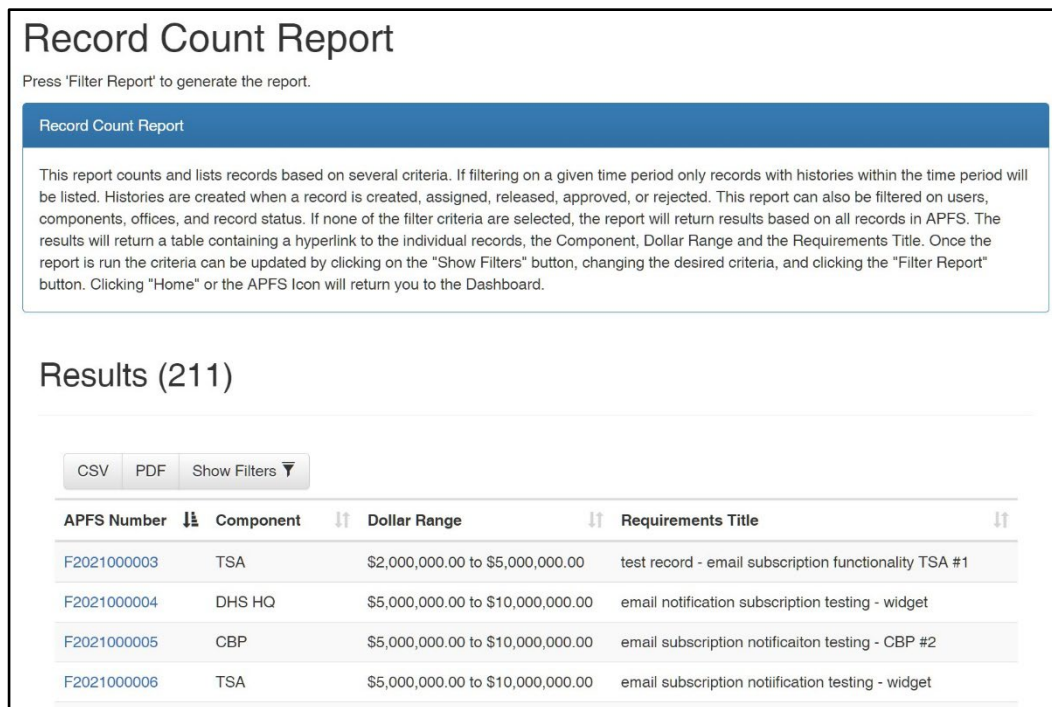


Figure 27: Record Count Report

## 2. How can I generate a Record Count Report?

This report counts and lists records within your scope of influence based on several criteria. If filtering on a given time period only records with histories within the time period will be listed.

- A. Histories are created when a record is created, assigned, released, approved, or rejected. This report can also be filtered on users, components, offices, and record status.
- B. To generate a Record Count Report, choose desired criteria for the report.
- C. If none of the filter criteria are selected, the report will return results based on all records in APFS within your influence.
- D. Click the blue 'Filter Report' button to submit (see Figure 26).
- E. You will be redirected to the resulting report for the criteria selected (see Figure 27).
- F. The results will return a table containing a hyperlink to the individual records, the Component, Dollar Range and the Requirements Title.
- G. To edit, add, or remove selected filters, click the 'Show Filters' button to bring up a filter overlay. Make necessary changes and click 'Filter Report.'
- H. Clicking "Home" or the APFS Icon will return you to the Dashboard.

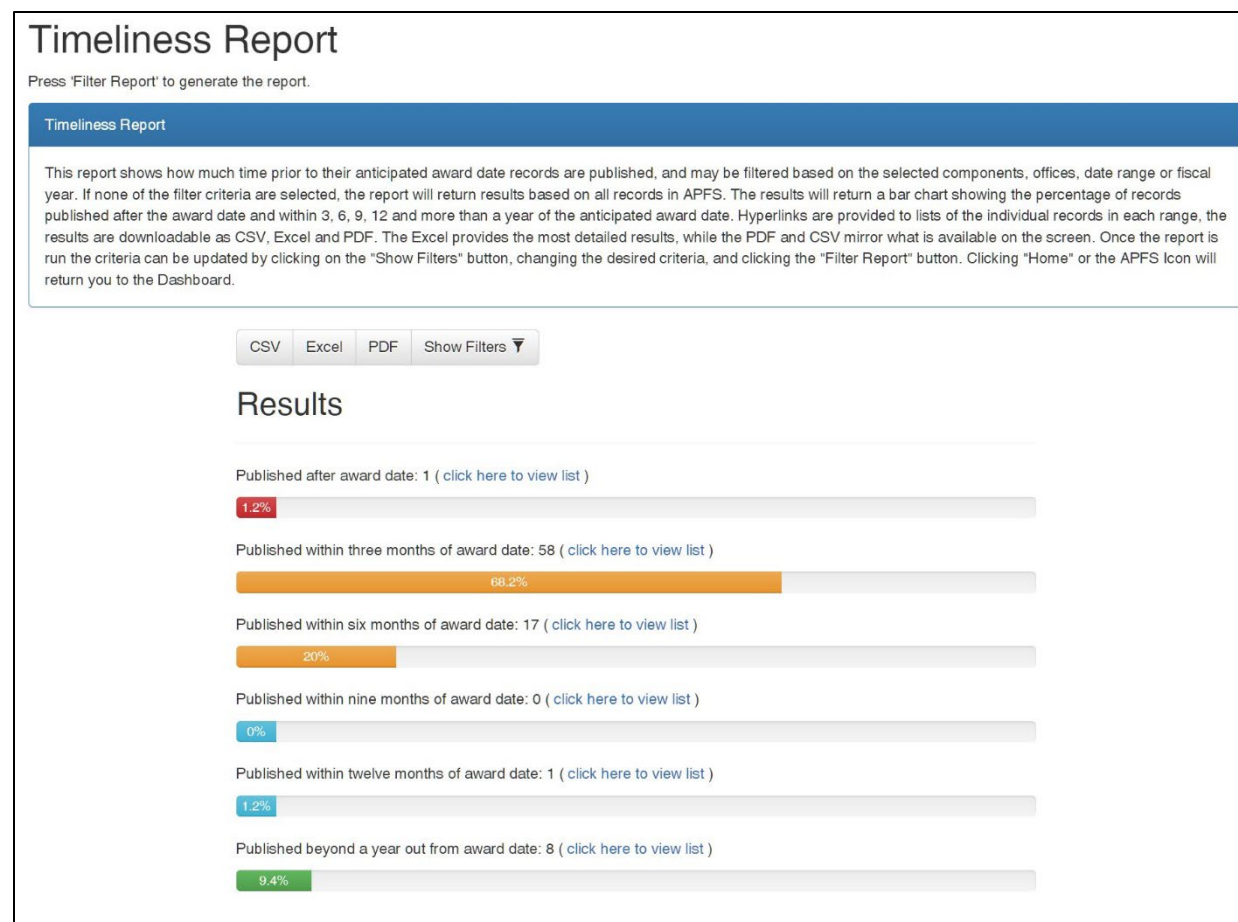


Figure 28: Timeliness Report

### 3. How can I generate a Timeliness Report?

This report shows how much time prior to their anticipated award records within your scope of influence are published, and may be filtered based on the selected components, offices, date range or fiscal year.

- To generate a Timeliness Report, select desired criteria for reporting.
- If none of the filter criteria are selected, the report will return results based on all records in APFS within your scope of influence.
- Click the blue 'Filter Report' button.
- You will be redirected to the resulting report for criteria selected (see Figure 28).
- The results will return a bar chart showing the percentage of records published after the award date and within 3, 6, 9, 12 and more than a year of the anticipated award date.
- Hyperlinks are provided to lists of the individual records in each range, the results are downloadable as CSV, Excel and PDF.
- To edit, add, or remove selected filters, and click the 'Show Filters' button to bring up a filter overlay. Make necessary changes and click 'Filter Report.'
- Clicking "Home" or the APFS Icon will return you to the Dashboard.



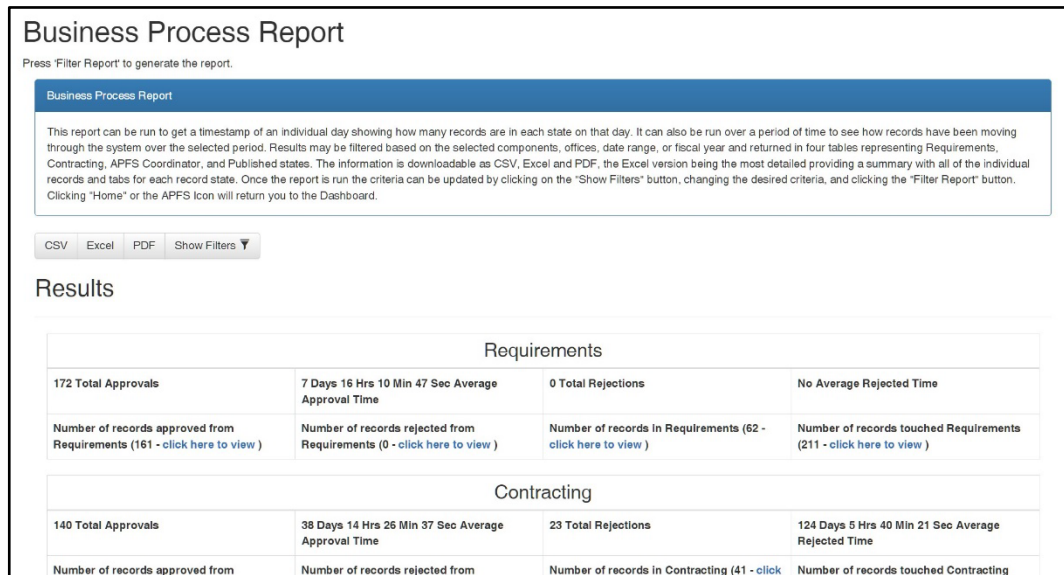


Figure 29: Business Process Report

#### 4. How can I generate a Business Process Report?

This report can be run to get a timestamp of an individual day showing how many records within your scope of influence are in each state on that day. It can also be run over a period of time to see how records have been moving through the system over the selected period. Results may be filtered based on the selected components and offices within your influence, date range, or fiscal year and are returned in four tables representing Requirements, Contracting, APFS Coordinator, and Published states.

- To generate a Business Process Report, select desired criteria for reporting.
- Click the blue 'Filter Report' button.
- You will be redirected to the resulting report for criteria selected (see Figure 29).
- The information is downloadable as CSV, Excel and PDF. The Excel version provides the most detailed providing a summary with all of the individual records and tabs for each record state.
- To edit, add, or remove selected filters, and click the 'Show Filters' button to bring up a filter overlay. Make necessary changes and click 'Filter Report.'
- Clicking "Home" or the APFS Icon will return you to the Dashboard.